

Liberty County — 2026 Building Permit Authorization & Eligibility Guide

Updated September 17, 2026 · Statutes verified June 2026: Chapter 489 (Contracting), Chapter 320 (Mobile Homes), Chapter 163 (Land Use), FAC 15C-2, and FS 471/472

IMPORTANT — OWNER-BUILDER EXEMPTION APPLIES TO OWNER-OCCUPIED PROPERTY ONLY

Florida Statute 489.103(7) limits the owner-builder exemption to property the owner personally occupies or uses. It does NOT apply to rental property, investment property, or any property offered for lease. If you own a rental home, duplex, or any property currently leased or intended to be leased, you CANNOT use the owner-builder exemption — a licensed contractor is required for all permitted work on that property, regardless of permit type.

Each row's tier is labeled at the top of the "Who Can PULL the Permit?" column: OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK · OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR (owner-occupied property only) · LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED.

Permit Type	Unit / Details	2026 Fee	Who Can PULL the Permit?	Who Can DO the Work?	License Required?	FL Statute / Authority	Conditions & Notes
New construction							
Residential Building Permit	Per Square Foot	\$0.75 / sq ft	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed GC	Owner-Builder (own use/occupancy) OR Licensed General Contractor	GC license required if using contractor	FS 489.103(7)(a)	Owner-builder exemption applies to 1–2 family residences for owner's own use, not for sale/lease. Owner must personally appear, sign affidavit, and directly supervise all work. Cannot hire unlicensed persons.
Commercial Building Permit	Per Square Foot	\$0.85 / sq ft	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed GC Required	Licensed General Contractor	Yes — CGC License (DBPR certified)	FS 489.103(7); FS 489.113	Owner-builder exception ONLY if construction cost ≤ \$75,000 AND for owner's own use/occupancy. All other commercial work requires a licensed General Contractor.
Factory-Built (Modular) Commercial Building	Per Square Foot — site work only	\$0.35 / sq ft	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed GC Required	Licensed General Contractor	Yes — CGC License (DBPR certified)	FS 553.80(1)(d); FS 489.113	Building must bear a valid State of Florida (DBPR) insignia; the rate covers erection, assembly, foundation, and anchoring only. Foundation and anchoring plans sealed by a Florida-licensed PE are required. A metal or aluminum kit building with no insignia is charged the standard commercial rate of \$0.85 / sq ft. Electrical, plumbing, mechanical, and site plan review are charged separately.
Plumbing, HVAC, Gas & Mechanical	Flat Rate — New Construction	\$150.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Subcontractor Only	Licensed Plumbing / HVAC / Mechanical Contractor	Yes — Specialty license (Plumbing, HVAC, Gas)	FS 489.113(3)(a); FS 489.105(3)	GC must subcontract plumbing, HVAC, and gas to appropriately licensed specialty contractors. No owner-builder exception for gas/mechanical systems regardless of project size.
Fire Suppression / Hood / Sprinkler System	New Construction, Renovation, or Repair	\$100.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Contractor Only	Licensed Fire Suppression Contractor	Yes — Fire Suppression Contractor license	FS 489.105(3)(g); FS 633	Life-safety system — no owner-builder exception under any circumstances. Must be pulled and performed by a certified fire suppression contractor.
Pre-manufactured Accessory Dwelling Unit	Flat Rate	\$150.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor (permit application)	Licensed Mobile Home Installer for setup; Licensed trades for utilities	Yes — Mobile Home Installer Lic. (FS 320.8249) for setup	FS 320.8249; FAC 15C-2.0073	Owner may submit permit application but physical setup must be performed by a licensed mobile home installer per FS 320.8249. Electrical and utility connections require licensed trades separately.
Electrical							
Electrical — Residential (New Service & Upgrades)	Residential	\$150.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed Electrician	Owner (own single-family / duplex, own use) OR Licensed Electrical Contractor	Yes — Electrical Contractor license if using contractor	FS 489.503(1); FS 489.103(7)	FS 489.503(1) grants owner-builder electrical exemption for single-family or duplex for own use. Property may not be for sale or lease. Owner must personally apply and cannot hire unlicensed subcontractors.

Permit Type	Unit / Details	2026 Fee	Who Can PULL the Permit?	Who Can DO the Work?	License Required?	FL Statute / Authority	Conditions & Notes
Electrical — Residential (Interior Wiring)	Existing service, meter & panel unchanged	\$125.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed Electrician	Owner (own single-family / duplex, own use) OR Licensed Electrical Contractor	Yes — Electrical Contractor license if using contractor	FS 489.503(1); FS 489.103(7)	Interior wiring rate applies only when the existing service, meter, and panel stay unchanged; if any of them is replaced or upsized, the new service rate applies instead. FS 489.503(1) grants owner-builder electrical exemption for single-family or duplex for own use. Property may not be for sale or lease. Owner must personally apply and cannot hire unlicensed subcontractors.
Electrical — Commercial (New Service & Upgrades)	Commercial	\$200.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Electrical Contractor Only	Licensed Electrical Contractor	Yes — Electrical Contractor license (DBPR certified)	FS 489.503; FS 489.537	Commercial electrical work requires a licensed electrical contractor. Owner-builder exception limited to projects under \$75,000 for owner's own occupancy.
Electrical — Commercial (Interior Wiring)	Existing service, meter & panel unchanged	\$175.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Electrical Contractor Only	Licensed Electrical Contractor	Yes — Electrical Contractor license (DBPR certified)	FS 489.503; FS 489.537	Interior wiring rate applies only when the existing service, meter, and panel stay unchanged; if any of them is replaced or upsized, the new service rate applies instead. Commercial electrical work requires a licensed electrical contractor. Owner-builder exception limited to projects under \$75,000 for owner's own occupancy.
Electrical — Reconnect / Release	No interior work and no change to the service	\$50.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder (own residence) OR Licensed Electrician	Owner (own single-family / duplex, own use) OR Licensed Electrical Contractor	Yes — Electrical Contractor license if using contractor; required for commercial	FS 489.503(1); FS 489.503	Inspection and release to the power company where no other electrical work is done. The owner-builder exemption covers only the owner's own single-family home or duplex; a commercial reconnect follows the commercial electrical rules.
Electrical — Outlets & Switches	Outlets and Switches	\$50.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed Electrician	Owner (own single-family / duplex, own use) OR Licensed Electrician	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.503(1)	Same owner-builder electrical exemption applies. Owner may perform work in own single-family or duplex for own use. Property may not be offered for sale or lease. Cannot hire unlicensed persons.
Solar — Panels & Wiring	Panels and Wiring	\$100.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Owner or Contractor (permit application)	Licensed Electrical Contractor REQUIRED for ALL wiring	Yes — Electrical Contractor license required for wiring	FS 489.103(7)(a)(3)	Statute is explicit: even under an owner-builder permit, a licensed electrical contractor MUST perform all wiring of solar panels and any interconnection to the home's electrical system. No exceptions.
Renovations							
Plumbing, Gas, Mechanical — Residential	Residential	\$150.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Subcontractor Only	Licensed Plumbing / HVAC / Gas Contractor	Yes — Specialty license (Plumbing, HVAC, Gas)	FS 489.113(3)(a)	Gas and mechanical systems must be performed by an appropriately licensed specialty contractor. No owner-builder exception for gas, regardless of residential classification.
Plumbing, Gas, Mechanical — Commercial	Commercial	\$200.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Subcontractor Only	Licensed Plumbing / HVAC / Gas Contractor	Yes — Specialty license (Plumbing, HVAC, Gas)	FS 489.113(3)(a)	Same requirement as residential — licensed specialty contractor required. GC must subcontract these trades.
Windows & Siding	Flat Rate	\$50.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor	Owner (own home, own use) OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor (Building or Residential Lic.)	FS 489.103(7)	Owner-builder exemption applies to owner-occupied property. Any contractor hired must hold a valid Building or Residential Contractor license.
Mobile homes							

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Mobile Home Set-Up Permit	Flat Rate — All Sizes (Does NOT include electrical)	\$300.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor (permit application only)	Licensed Mobile Home Installer REQUIRED for physical setup	Yes — Mobile Home Installer License (FS 320.8249) required for installation	FS 320.8249; FAC 15C-2.0073; FS 489.103(7)	Owner may pull the permit but CANNOT perform the installation. FAC 15C-2.0073 states no person may perform mobile home setup unless licensed under FS 320.8249 — this supersedes the general owner-builder exemption in FS 489. Electrical connections require a separately licensed electrician.
Mobile Home Park — Development Plan Review	Due when the park plans are submitted	\$1,000.00 or \$25.00 per space, whichever is greater	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Authorized Agent	N/A — Administrative Review	PE or Architect seal may be required for plans	Land Development Code 4.6-1; Local LDR; FS 163	Plan review for developing a new mobile home park, with the fee set by the Land Development Code. Park plans may need to be sealed by a Florida Licensed Professional Engineer. Each home placed in the park still needs its own Mobile Home Set-Up Permit.
Roofing							
Roofing Permit — Small	1 – 1,000 Square Feet	\$50.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed Roofing Contractor	Owner (own 1–2 family residence, own use) OR Licensed Roofing Contractor	Yes — Roofing Contractor license if using contractor	FS 489.103(7); FS 489.113(3)(g)	Owner-builder exemption applies to own 1–2 family residence for personal use. General Contractors certified after 1973 may NOT self-perform roofing unless also certified as a roofing contractor (FS 489.113(g)).
Roofing Permit — Standard	1,000 Square Feet and Up	\$100.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner-Builder OR Licensed Roofing Contractor	Owner (own 1–2 family residence, own use) OR Licensed Roofing Contractor	Yes — Roofing Contractor license if using contractor	FS 489.103(7); FS 489.113(3)(g)	Same owner-builder rules apply. If owner sells or leases within 1 year of completion, law presumes it was built for sale/lease — a violation of the exemption. Licensed roofer strongly advised for full replacements.
Accessory buildings (non-residential)							
Accessory Building — Open	Roof only, no walls (formerly Pole Barn)	\$125.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Contractor	Owner OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.103(7)(a)(1) (farm outbuildings)	FS 489.103(7)(a)(1) specifically exempts farm outbuildings. Owner may build on own property. Any electrical or plumbing inside still requires licensed subcontractors.
Accessory Building — Enclosed	Any walls, full or partial (formerly Pole Barn)	\$150.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Contractor	Owner OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.103(7)(a)(1) (farm outbuildings)	Same farm outbuilding exemption applies. Interior electrical or plumbing work requires licensed subcontractors.
Accessory Building — Enclosing Existing Open	Adding full or partial walls to a structure previously permitted as open	\$50.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Contractor	Owner OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.103(7)(a)(1) (farm outbuildings)	Applies only if the open structure was previously permitted; if it was never permitted, the Enclosed fee applies. Plan review and inspection are required because enclosing changes the wind-design classification. Interior electrical or plumbing work requires licensed subcontractors.
Portable Sheds & Garages	120 – 400 Square Feet	\$30.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner OK	Owner OK	No license required	FS 489.103(7)	Small accessory structures on owner's property generally do not require a licensed contractor. Must still meet setback, zoning, and wind load requirements.
Portable Sheds & Garages	Over 400 Square Feet	\$50.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor	Owner OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.103(7); local LDR	Larger structures may require engineered drawings. Verify requirements with Liberty County Building Department.
Comprehensive plan review & zoning							
Site Plan Approval — Tier 1	Single-Family Homes, Mobile Home Setups, Simple Additions	\$100.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Authorized Agent	N/A — Administrative Review	No license required to apply	Local LDR; FS 163	Owner or authorized agent may submit application. No contractor license needed for the application itself.

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Site Plan Approval — Tier 2	Industrial, Commercial, Multifamily	\$350.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Authorized Agent	N/A — Administrative Review	PE or Architect seal may be required for plans	Local LDR; FS 163; FS 471 (PE); FS 481 (RA)	Complex projects may require site plans sealed by a Florida Licensed Professional Engineer (PE) or Registered Architect (RA). Contact planning dept. to confirm plan requirements.
Comp Plan Amendment — Small-Scale	Under 10 Acres	\$1,500.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Attorney / Agent	N/A — County Commission Review	No	FS 163.3187	Any owner or authorized representative may submit. Planning consultant recommended but not legally required.
Comp Plan Amendment — Large-Scale	Over 10 Acres	\$5,000.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Attorney / Agent	N/A — County Commission Review	No	FS 163.3184	Open to any applicant. State agency (DEO) review required for large-scale amendments.
Amendment to Land Development Regulations		\$1,500.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Agent	N/A — County Review	No	FS 163.3202	Legislative/regulatory change request. Open to any applicant.
Subdivision Plat Approval		\$1,000.00 or \$25.00 per lot, whichever is greater	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Authorized Agent	N/A — Requires Licensed Surveyor & Mapper	Yes — Florida Licensed Surveyor & Mapper (PSM) must seal the plat	FS 177.011; FS 472	Plat MUST be prepared and sealed by a Florida Professional Surveyor and Mapper (PSM). Owner or agent submits the application; licensed surveyor performs the technical work.
Property Split Review	Comp Plan Review Prior to Property Split	\$150.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Agent	N/A — Administrative	No	Local LDR	Owner or authorized agent submits application. Administrative staff review only.
Application for Special Exception		\$1,000.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Agent	N/A — Board of Adjustment Review	No	FS 163.225; Local LDR	Heard by Board of Adjustment. Owner or authorized agent may apply without a contractor license.
Variance		\$350.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Agent	N/A — Board of Adjustment Review	No	FS 163.225; Local LDR	Dimensional relief request. Owner or authorized agent may apply.
Conditional uses & miscellaneous							
Other Conditional Uses		\$2,000.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Authorized Agent	N/A — County Commission Review	No	Local LDR; FS 163	Contact Liberty County Planning Department for requirements specific to the conditional use category.
Special Temporary Use Permit	Issued by Commission	\$200.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Applicant	N/A — Temporary Use	No	Local LDR	Events or temporary uses requiring Commission approval. Applicant submits directly.
Special Temporary Use Permit	Issued by Staff / Clerk	\$50.00	OWNER MAY PULL & DO THE WORK Owner or Applicant	N/A — Temporary Use	No	Local LDR	Minor temporary uses approved at the staff level.
Decks and Ramps		\$100.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor	Owner OR Licensed Contractor	Yes — if using contractor	FS 489.103(7); Local LDR	Owner-builder may construct a deck or ramp on owner-occupied property. Any electrical (outdoor lighting or outlets) requires a separate Electrical permit.
Porch, Covered Patio or Attached Carport	Roofed, open sides, attached to a dwelling	125	may build a porch on owner-occupied property. The roof ties into the dwelling, so it is permitted as part of the house, not as an accessory bu				

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Sign Permit		\$100.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner or Contractor	Owner (non-electrical signs) OR Licensed Contractor (electrical/illuminated signs)	Yes — Electrical Contractor license if sign has electrical components	FS 489.105; Local LDR	Non-electrical signs: owner may install on own property. Electrical or illuminated signs: licensed electrical contractor required for all wiring.
Swimming Pool	All Sizes	\$100.00	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Pool Contractor Only	Licensed Swimming Pool / Spa Contractor (CPC)	Yes — CPC License FS 489.105(3)(j–l)	FS 489.103(6); FS 489.113(3)(c)	FS 489.103(6) explicitly states the owner-builder exemption does NOT apply to in-ground pools/spas involving excavation, plumbing, chemicals, or wiring. Licensed pool/spa contractor (CPC) required for all pool construction.
Conditional Land Use — Communication Tower	Communication Tower	\$3,500 + \$3,000 refundable escrow	LICENSED CONTRACTOR REQUIRED Licensed Contractor / Authorized Applicant	Licensed Contractor + PE-sealed structural plans	Yes — GC License; PE structural seal required	FS 489.113; FS 471; FCC rules	Tower construction requires a structural engineer (PE seal) and licensed general contractor. Land Development Code 8.5-8.7: the \$3,500 application fee is non-refundable; the \$3,000 consultant escrow is refundable and must be topped up if drawn to zero; a performance bond of at least \$75,000 is also required.
Conditional Land Use — Co-Location on Existing Tower	Co-Location on Existing Tower	\$2,000.00	OWNER OR LICENSED CONTRACTOR Owner / Carrier or Contractor	Licensed Contractor	Yes — Contractor License	FS 489.113; FCC rules	Equipment installation on an existing tower requires a licensed contractor. The co-location carrier or tower owner submits the application; the contractor performs the installation work. The \$2,000.00 fee is non-refundable (Land Development Code 8.6).
Inspections							
Additional Inspection	Beyond the inspections included with the permit — added or altered work, a partial inspection, or one requested out of sequence	\$50.00	Permit Holder	N/A — County Inspector	No	Local fee schedule	Charged per trip. Must be paid before the inspection is scheduled.
Re-Inspection	Each re-inspection after the first, when work failed or was not ready	\$50.00	Permit Holder	N/A — County Inspector	No	Local fee schedule	The first re-inspection is not charged. Must be paid before the inspection is scheduled.

Additional permit rules — apply to all permits listed above		
Plan Review	Included in the building permit fee — no separate plan review fee	Added to permit fee at time of application.
Third Party Inspection	40% discount on the permit fee	Liberty County may allow approved third-party inspectors. Confirm with building dept.
Permit Expiration & Extension	Expires 1 year from issuance. Extensions granted on written request, no fee. No renewal fee.	Applies to expired permits. Contact building dept. before work resumes.
Private Provider (s. 553.791, F.S.)	Statutory minimum: at least 25% off for plan review or inspection, at least 50% off when both are used	
PENALTY — Work Before Permit	DOUBLE FEE if work is started before the permit is pulled	Work begun prior to permit issuance = 2× the standard permit fee. Applies to all permit types.
NO PERMIT REQUIRED — \$7,500 Cosmetic Exemption (HB 803)	Strictly cosmetic, non-structural work on a single-family home under \$7,500 total declared value. Does NOT apply to electrical, plumbing, mechanical, gas, or structural work at any value. VOID in a designated flood hazard area. Project splitting prohibited. Signed Written Request for Exemption (HB 803) required before work begins.	

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NO PERMIT REQUIRED — Temporary Hurricane / Flood Walls (HB 803)	Separate exemption, no dollar threshold, for a temporary residential hurricane or flood wall meeting the specified standards. Confirm the applicable standard with the Building Official.						

DISCLAIMER: This guide is intended as a public reference only. Permit eligibility is governed by Florida Statutes Chapters 489, 320, 163, 177, 471, 472, 481, and applicable Florida Administrative Code rules, as well as Liberty County Local Development Regulations. Requirements may change. Always confirm current requirements with the Liberty County Building Department or County Attorney before beginning any project. This guide does not constitute legal advice.